Design Doc Skeleton — 10-Minute Team Sketch

Project _____

Ten minutes, as a team, out loud. **Boxes, not a finished diagram** — this is the starting point for the architecture workshop, not its output. Each part lines up with a section of the *Design Document Template*.

1 · System context → TEMPLATE §3

Your system is the one box. Around it: **every kind of user** *and* **every service you depend on but don't control**. *Label each arrow with what crosses the boundary.*

USERS

EXTERNAL SERVICES

YOUR SYSTEM

_____

What does it depend on that you don't control? Where does the data live?

2 · Three to five components → TEMPLATE §4

One job each, in one line. If two rows have the same job, merge them; if a row needs "and," it may be two.

COMPONENT	ITS ONE JOB	TALKS TO

3 · Data the core flow touches → TEMPLATE §5

Entities and a few key fields — not every column. Stick to the data your most important user action reads or writes.

ENTITY	KEY FIELDS	RELATES TO

4 · The two biggest decisions → TEMPLATE §6

The choices you'll have to argue, each against an alternative a reasonable team would **actually pick**. *Can't name two? Go back to your proposal's risks and your spike — that's where they are.*

Decision _____
Leaning toward _____
Real alternative _____
What would settle it _____

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Bring this to the architecture workshop. The workshop turns it into your draft.